

Online Resource 1 — Sentiment Annotation Guideline

Supplementary material for “Auditing Label Reliability and Data Leakage in Auto-Labelled Social-Media Sentiment Corpora: A Case Study on FIFA World Cup Tweets”

1 Task

You will read 500 English tweets collected on the opening day of the FIFA World Cup 2022 (hashtag #WorldCup2022). For each tweet, assign exactly one sentiment label — **Positive**, **Neutral**, or **Negative** — using the dropdown in the **sentiment** column of your assigned worksheet tab. Work **independently**. Do not discuss tweets with other annotators and do not consult any automatic or pre-existing labels until all annotations are complete.

2 Label definitions

- **Positive** — the author expresses approval, enthusiasm, excitement, praise, joy, or support (e.g. celebrating a goal, a team, or the tournament).
- **Negative** — the author expresses disapproval, anger, disappointment, criticism, sarcasm, complaint, or hostility (e.g. criticising officiating, broadcasting, or the host).
- **Neutral** — the tweet is primarily factual, logistical, a question, an announcement, or otherwise carries no clear positive or negative stance (e.g. score updates, schedules, links).

3 Decision rules

Apply these rules in order when a tweet is ambiguous:

1. **Sarcasm/irony.** Label the author’s *intended* sentiment, not the literal wording. “Brilliant refereeing as usual . . .” meaning the opposite is **Negative**.
2. **Mixed sentiment.** If both polarities appear, label the *dominant* one. If they are genuinely balanced with no dominant polarity, label **Neutral**.
3. **Factual / interrogative.** Purely informational statements, questions, scores, schedules, and shared links with no evaluative stance are **Neutral**.
4. **Emoji and hashtags.** Interpret emoji and evaluative hashtags as part of the sentiment (e.g. a laughing/celebratory emoji can make an otherwise neutral sentence Positive; a critical hashtag can make it Negative).
5. **Target-independence.** Label the sentiment the author *expresses*, regardless of whether you agree or whether it targets a team, player, official, broadcaster, or the host nation.

4 Worked examples

- “What a horrific first game. The Netherlands should be ashamed . . .” — **Negative** (explicit criticism).
- “How much did Qatar pay for that offside? :) #WorldCup2022” — **Negative** (sarcastic accusation; intended, not literal).
- “Kick-off times for today’s #WorldCup2022 fixtures below.” — **Neutral** (purely informational).
- “Unreal atmosphere, buzzing for this tournament! #WorldCup2022” — **Positive** (enthusiasm).

5 Procedure and quality control

- Label every one of the 500 rows; do not leave blanks.
- Do not change earlier labels after seeing later tweets unless correcting a clear slip.
- You were *not* shown the dataset’s automatic labels or other annotators’ labels during annotation.
- Annotator background: *[to be completed — e.g. number of annotators, field of study, English proficiency, demographic range]*.

Aggregated annotations, agreement analysis, and code are available at https://github.com/marufbangabashi/NLP_Paper